



Q.20) "As India is becoming increasingly urbanized, there is a need to address the presence of striking inequalities in the urban centres and make them more socially and financially inclusive". Examine. How can various government initiatives be streamlined to achieve these objectives? (15 Marks, 250 Words)

"भारत में तेजी से बढ़ते शहरीकरण में व्याप्त असमानताओं की उपस्थिति को दूर करने और उन्हें सामाजिक और आर्थिक रूप से समावेशी बनाने की आवश्यकता है। इन उद्देश्यों को प्राप्त करने के लिए विभिन्न सरकारी पहलों को कैसे सुव्यवस्थित किया जा सकता है? चर्चा करें। (15 अंक, 250 शब्द)

According to Census 2011, India had 30% urban population which is set to rise to 50% by 2050.

This urbanisation however is characterised by distress, mismanagement and being skewed, sudden & haphazard.

Striking inequality in urban areas is characterised by .

- Unemployment levels
- Urban poverty
- Slummification of urban centres
- lack of facilities - housing, water, health & education
- Skewed urbanisation tilted towards tier 1 & 2 cities
- Urban sprawl & peri urbanisation,

Socially

- There is ghettoisation and gentrification in cities leading to lack of social cohesion & social capital
- Rise in crimes in urban areas due to inequalities materialising as conflicts
- Son of soil tendencies create further social isolation.

Financially

- Urbanisation is not occurring parallel to industrialisation & job creation
- Thus, financially urban migrants lack capital, job security and financial security.
- Financial inclusion drive is needed in cities.
- Affordability of urban areas is a cause of concern.

Various Govt Initiatives can be streamlined towards reducing inequality by :

1. Creation of affordable housing & rental facilities through PM Awas Yojana (U)
2. AMRUT & Smart cities mission should be so streamlined to ensure cities are planned to reduce transportation, housing costs.
3. Ahluwalia Committee Report suggests contracting out services like Solid waste management to enhance efficiency.
4. Swachh Bharat Abhiyan Urban to ensure hygiene in urban areas.
5. Slum redevelopment programmes should be inclusive of people living in slums.
6. National Urban Livelihood Mission to tackle the unemployment concerns and create social capital.

Thus, modern day cities have to be socially & financially inclusive to remain sustainable as envisioned by SDG 11.

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Structure		Content	
Question Interpretation		Total :	